2026-2027 EDITION

Hotel Operations and Innovation

Industry Workplace Based Retraining Programme for the Republic of Uzbekistan

Samarkand International Academy in collaboration with UN Tourism





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Hotel Industry Retraining Programme

- Flagship, forward-looking, industry-relevant upskilling Programme across Uzbekistan
- Highly selective, designed for Hotel Middle Management including Department Heads, Managers and Supervisors
- Combining in-person training, individual workplace application, structured online learning and mentoring
- Designed and delivered with leading international experts

A Practical, Workplace-Based Cascade Approach

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This Programme is built on a single, powerful principle: learning that stays in the classroom rarely changes a workplace

We developed a **cascade model**: every manager and supervisor who participates becomes a conduit for improvement, multiplying the programme's impact far beyond the original cohort and creating a lasting culture of learning within Uzbekistan's hospitality sector.

By **embedding professional development directly into daily hotel operations**, participants acquire knowledge they can immediately apply, adapt, and share with the colleagues around them.

The aim is to cascade the new knowledge, skills and tools to 5-10 colleagues.





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Programme Objectives

Strengthen operational performance, leadership, service quality and digital capability within **Uzbekistan's hospitality industry by developing practicing hotel managers and supervisors who can apply learning** in their workplaces **and transfer** practical knowledge to operational employees.

This aim reflects a deliberate focus on **real-world impact**.

The Programme aims to bring **tangible improvements** participants can introduce into their hotels – resulting in better guest experiences, stronger teams, and smarter, more efficient operations.

Programme Objectives

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Operations & Knowledge

Strengthen technical knowledge in key areas of hotel operations and support multi-skilling and cross-training across departments.

Leadership & Coaching

Improve supervisory leadership, coaching and workplace-training skills so that participants become effective on-the-job developers of their teams.

Guest Experience

Support measurable improvements in service quality and the overall guest experience across participating properties.

Digital & Data

Encourage the use of digital tools, artificial intelligence and data-informed decision-making in everyday hotel management.

Sustainability & Scale

Promote sustainability, productivity and cost awareness, and develop a delivery model that can be scaled or replicated nationally.

Target Audience

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The programme will primarily recruit **practicing hotel mid-level managers and supervisors** who are responsible for operational departments and frontline teams. Both branded international hotels and locally owned and managed properties are warmly encouraged to apply.

This dual focus ensures the Programme builds capability across the full breadth of Uzbekistan's growing hospitality landscape - from global-brand standards to the distinctive character of independent properties.

International Branded Hotels

Global standards, structured teams, established SOPs.

Locally Owned Properties

Independent character, community connection, growing professionalism.



Participant Eligibility Criteria

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1 Current Role

Hold a current mid-level management position in hotel operations and directly manage, coach or train operational employees

2 Industry Experience

At least **three years** of relevant hospitality industry experience and at least **one year** of supervisory or team-leadership experience

3 Workplace Access & Commitment

Employer permission to participate, sufficient workplace access to implement learning, commitment to all in-person sessions, online mentoring, and submission of the Portfolio of Evidence





Cohort Structure and Flexibility

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Core Cohort - Full Programme

The programme will primarily seek to establish a **core cohort** of hotel professionals who participate throughout the full programme, building a comprehensive, connected set of skills, enabling multi-skilling and cross-training.

This approach creates a peer learning community, participants grow together, share challenges, and support one another's workplace improvements.

Flexible Module-by-Module Access

Participation may also be opened on an **optional module-by-module basis**, allowing hotels to send relevant specialists to the modules most pertinent to their department or development priorities.

This flexibility broadens the programme's reach and respects the operational pressures that hotels face in managing rotas and staffing across busy periods.

Programme Structure

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7 Modules

Same format for every Module

In-Person (Face to Face)

- 16 hours
- Over two days
- Thursday/Friday
- Saturday/Sunday
- 9.00–13.00 and 14.00–18.00

In Person (Individual Workplace Application)

Minimum 4 hours — applying the knowledge, skills and tools directly in the workplace

Online

16 hours

10 hours of independent study (materials, case studies, SOP templates and checklists etc.) plus 6 hours of scheduled online mentoring with the expert



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1. Events and Banqueting Operations

Key areas will include:

- Start with the why – understanding client and guest needs
- Turn the brief into a plan – function sheets, checklists and timelines
- Ready before the guests are – room set-up and event readiness
- One event, one team – cross-departmental coordination
- Make the plan come alive – banquet service and event execution
- Expect the unexpected – managing last-minute changes
- Finish strong – post-event review and continuous improvement

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2. Front Office Operations

Key areas will include:

- First impressions, every time – the guest journey, from booking to arrival
- Match the room to the guest – reservations and room allocation
- Welcome in, send off well – check-in and check-out procedures
- The standard everyone can feel – service standards at the desk
- More than just a room – upselling and special requests
- Turn a problem into loyalty – complaint handling and service recovery
- Start the shift ready – shift briefings
- Grow the team behind the desk – coaching and supervising reception teams





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3. Modern Housekeeping and Guest Comfort

Key areas will include:

- Clean right, every time – cleaning standards and consistency
- Ready means ready – room readiness
- The details guests notice – comfort and attention to detail
- Inspect like a guest – room inspection and quality checks
- Right people, right rooms – workload and productivity planning
- Control what you use – linen and amenities management
- Clean smarter, waste less – sustainability and resource efficiency
- Digital housekeeping made simple – tools and checklists
- Start strong, finish strong – team briefings and performance

4. Modern Food and Beverage Service

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Key areas will include:

- Every table, every event – restaurant and banquet service
- The rhythm of great service – sequence of service and service standards
- Make it memorable – creating memorable guest experiences
- Tell the story on the plate – presenting local food and drink through storytelling
- Know it, recommend it – menu knowledge and confident recommendations
- Read the guest, adjust the service – guest interaction and personalised service
- Turn a complaint into a comeback – handling complaints and service recovery
- Brief before you serve – pre-service briefings and team coordination
- Coach the team that serves – coaching restaurant and banquet teams



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5. Sustainable Hotel Operations and Maintenance

Key areas will include:

- Spot it before it grows – identifying and reporting maintenance issues
- Report, repair, follow up – maintenance follow-through
- Check before it fails – simple operational checks
- Use less, save more – energy & water efficiency
- Waste less every day – waste reduction
- Make every resource count – efficient resource use
- Sustainability in action – sustainable daily operations
- Expect the unexpected – managing operational disruptions
- One hotel, one team – cross-departmental communication





6. Hotel Safety, Food Hygiene and Crisis Preparedness

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Key areas will include:

- Safety is everyone's job – guest and employee safety
- Protect the people who protect the guests – workplace health and safety
- Handle food like it matters – food hygiene and safe food handling
- Know what's in it – allergen awareness
- Spot the risk before it becomes an incident – risk assessment and incident reporting
- When it happens, be ready – emergency procedures and crisis response
- Stay calm, stay in control – conflict management and difficult situations
- Practise for the moment you hope never comes – practical emergency simulations
- Prepared, together – team briefings and preparedness



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7. Revenue Management

Key areas will include:

- Sell the right room at the right time – revenue management principles
- Know what's coming – demand forecasting and occupancy planning
- Price with purpose – dynamic pricing strategies
- Know your numbers – occupancy, ADR and RevPAR
- Know who is booking – market segmentation and customer mix
- Choose the right route to market – distribution and direct booking
- Turn data into decisions – revenue tools and analytics
- Every guest is an opportunity – upselling and cross-selling
- Review, react, improve – revenue performance and action planning

Cross Cutting Themes

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The following themes are woven throughout every module, ensuring that technical operational content is always connected to broader professional capability:

Leadership & Coaching

Supervisory leadership, coaching skills and workplace learning methodologies embedded in every session.

Guest Experience

Service quality improvement and consistently exceptional guest experience as a running thread across all modules.

Sustainability

Environmental responsibility, resource efficiency and sustainable practices integrated throughout operational learning.

Digital & AI

Digital innovation, artificial intelligence applications and data-informed decision-making for modern hotel management.

Productivity & Cost Control

Practical tools for improving productivity, managing costs and supporting continuous operational improvement.

Workplace Based Learning Transfer

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When the Topic is Directly Relevant

Where the module content relates directly to the participant's own department, they will apply and share the knowledge and skills **directly with their colleagues** through practical, on-the-job activities embedded in normal operations.

This direct transfer ensures that learning reaches frontline employees promptly and in a context they immediately recognise.

When the Topic is Less Directly Relevant

Where a module covers a department outside the participant's own role, they will **consult colleagues** in the relevant area, explore how the learning might apply, and share useful tips, tools and ideas where appropriate.

This cross-departmental curiosity strengthens collaboration and builds a more rounded understanding of hotel operations as a whole.

How it Happens in Practice

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Participants will not be expected to organise lengthy formal courses or prepare complex lesson plans. Instead, they will share selected practical learning through activities **already embedded in everyday hotel operations**:

Departmental Briefing

A short, focused team briefing before or after a shift.

Practical Demonstration

Showing a technique or procedure during live operations.

On-the-Job Coaching

Coaching an employee while completing a task together.

Staff Meeting Discussion

Raising a topic or sharing an insight during an existing team meeting.

SOP or Checklist Review

Introducing, explaining or reviewing a standard operating procedure or job aid.

Toolbox Talk

A brief safety or service exercise delivered to a small operational group.

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How it Happens in Practice

The Learning-Transfer Cycle

This simple, repeating cycle ensures that knowledge flows reliably from the classroom into daily hotel operations — creating continuous, cumulative improvement rather than a one-off training event.





How it Happens in Practice

Gradual, Sustained Knowledge Transfer

Working with a Consistent Team

Participants may work with the **same core group of employees** throughout the programme, building trust and familiarity that makes workplace learning more effective and genuinely developmental.

Repeated contact with the same colleagues allows participants to track progress, revisit topics, and deepen understanding over time — a far more powerful model than single-session delivery

Accumulated, Not Compressed

Workplace learning may be accumulated **gradually through several short activities** rather than delivered as one substantial formal training session.

This respects the operational realities of hotel management, where time is precious and schedules shift constantly.

A short briefing this week, a coaching conversation next week, and a checklist review the week after can together constitute a rich and meaningful learning experience for a frontline team.

Portfolio of Evidence

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Each participant will progressively prepare a simple workplace portfolio — a practical record of their applied learning and cascade knowledge transfer to their team members, kept proportionate and manageable for busy hospitality professionals

What to Record

- A brief record of topics shared, with dates and approximate duration
- Names or roles of participating employees
- Checklists, SOPs, briefing notes or job aids used
- Photos

What to Reflect On

- A short description of each workplace activity delivered
- A brief reflection on what was applied or improved as a result

Confirmation of Evidence

- Employer, supervisor or peer confirmation of workplace learning activities
- Evidence requirements remain proportionate throughout

The portfolio is designed to capture real work — not to create additional work. Evidence requirements are kept deliberately light, respecting participants' busy professional lives.

Certification Requirements

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1 Attendance

Attend all in-person sessions across the programme modules.

2 Digital Learning

Complete all required digital-learning activities between in-person sessions.

3 Mentoring

Actively participate in online mentoring sessions throughout the programme.

4 Workplace Learning

Deliver verified workplace learning involving the agreed number of employees and the required applied face-to-face learning hours.

5 Portfolio Submission

Submit a satisfactory workplace portfolio by the end of April 2027, demonstrating applied learning and reflective practice.





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Attendance Requirements

- 80% attendance or above at all on-site and on-line sessions (participation in mentoring and pre-submission Q&A on-line sessions)
- 100% completion of the required digital-learning activities on the learning platform
- Verified workplace learning involving the agreed number of employees and completion of the required applied face-to-face learning hours
- Submission of a satisfactory portfolio by the established deadline date of each Module

Programme Summary

Modules	Onsite Training *	Workplace-Based Application of Learning	Online Schedule	Portfolio Submission
Module 1 – Events and Banqueting Operations	4–6 December 2026 09:00–13:00 & 14:00–18:00 daily (8 hrs, incl. lunch break)	7–25 December 2026	10 & 17 Dec – Mentoring sessions (16:00 or 17:00) 23 Dec – Pre-submission Q&A (16:00 or 17:00)	28 December 2026
Module 2 – Front Office Operations	15–18 January 2027 09:00–13:00 & 14:00–18:00 daily (8 hrs, incl. lunch break)	19 January – 25 February 2027	21 & 28 Jan – Mentoring sessions (16:00 or 17:00) 4 Feb – Pre-submission Q&A (16:00 or 17:00)	5 February 2027
Module 3 – Modern Housekeeping and Guest Comfort	15–18 January 2027 09:00–13:00 & 14:00–18:00 daily (8 hrs, incl. lunch break)	19 January – 25 February 2027	21 & 28 Jan – Mentoring sessions (16:00 or 17:00) 4 Feb – Pre-submission Q&A (16:00 or 17:00)	5 February 2027
Module 4 – Modern Food and Beverage Service	26 February – 1 March 2027 09:00–13:00 & 14:00–18:00 daily (8 hrs, incl. lunch break)	2–25 March 2027	11 & 18 Mar – Mentoring sessions (16:00 or 17:00) 25 Mar – Pre-submission Q&A (16:00 or 17:00)	26 March 2027
Module 5 – Sustainable Hotel Operations and Maintenance	26 February – 1 March 2027 09:00–13:00 & 14:00–18:00 daily (8 hrs, incl. lunch break)	2–25 March 2027	11 & 18 Mar – Mentoring sessions (16:00 or 17:00) 25 Mar – Pre-submission Q&A (16:00 or 17:00)	26 March 2027
Module 6 – Hotel Safety, Food Hygiene and Crisis Preparedness	26–29 March 2027 09:00–13:00 & 14:00–18:00 daily (8 hrs, incl. lunch break)	30 March – 23 April 2027	8 & 15 Apr – Mentoring sessions (16:00 or 17:00) 22 Apr – Pre-submission Q&A (16:00 or 17:00)	23 April 2027
Module 7 – Revenue Management	26–29 March 2027 09:00–13:00 & 14:00–18:00 daily (8 hrs, incl. lunch break)	30 March – 23 April 2027	8 & 15 Apr – Mentoring sessions (16:00 or 17:00) 22 Apr – Pre-submission Q&A (16:00 or 17:00)	23 April 2027
Programme Completion and Closure	—	—	Portfolio assessment and moderation (late April) Closing Ceremony (May 2027)	—

** Dates are subject to minor changes for operational reasons*

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Registration Period: 26 September – 1 November 2026

Interested hotels are invited to complete the online registration form during the registration period using the QR code or registration link provided below.

LINK / QR CODE: **https://survey.zohopublic.com/zs/jQCZao**

The Training Programme has a limited capacity of 30 participants.

While individual Modules may be taken separately, participants are strongly recommended to complete the full Training Programme in order to benefit from the complete learning pathway and obtain the full Programme certification.

Thank you!

We look forward to welcoming your employees to the 2026–2027 Hotel Operations and Innovation Programme.

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